

HOWARD REID

Vice President / Senior Director, Information Technology

Enterprise IT & Applications | Cloud, Security & Identity | Modernization, AI & Automation
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Technology executive with 27+ years leading enterprise IT, enterprise applications, ERP, cloud infrastructure, and information security inside private equity-backed, acquisition-driven organizations. Built and standardized the technology function for a 27-company portfolio spanning 17 industries — 11 acquisitions, 6 ground-up company builds, and 3 divestitures — owning \$12M–\$15M budgets and 30+ multidisciplinary staff. ERP experience across Microsoft Dynamics NAV and Dynamics 365, Epicor (including AS/400 replacement), and Odoo, spanning selection, migration, and multi-site implementation. Currently architects and operates production AI agent platforms with governance, autonomy tiering, and cost control enforced in code. Based in the Dallas-Fort Worth Metroplex.

SIGNATURE IMPACT

- \$5M+ recurring annual synergies delivered across 11 acquisitions, 6 ground-up company builds, and 3 divestitures
- ERP across Dynamics NAV → Dynamics 365, AS/400 → Epicor, and Odoo — selection, migration, and multi-site implementation
- \$750K annual savings from Azure and Microsoft 365 optimization (165+ servers migrated), 35% infrastructure cost reduction, and 20% vendor cost optimization at renewal
- 100% MFA adoption, enterprise Zero Trust deployment, and 85% reduction in security incidents
- 27+ PE portfolio companies across 17 industries; \$12M–\$15M budgets owned and 30+ technology professionals led
- Production AI platforms built and operated personally — 20+ unattended services, governed autonomy tiers, and a \$400/month inference cost leak found and eliminated

LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIO

Enterprise IT • Enterprise Applications & Integrations • ERP Strategy, Selection & Implementation (Dynamics 365 / NAV, Epicor, Odoo) • Cloud Infrastructure (Microsoft Azure) • Information Security, Identity & Access Management • AI & Automation Governance • Enterprise Architecture & Systems Integration • Legacy Modernization & Technical Debt Reduction • M&A Technology Integration & Divestiture • Governance, Risk & Compliance • Vendor & Partner Strategy • IT Budget & Investment Planning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Technology Executive & Strategic Advisor

North Richland Hills, TX | Sep 2024 – Present

Advise private equity-backed and multi-company leadership teams on enterprise systems strategy, ERP selection, and IT organization design — while independently building and operating production AI platforms as founder and sole architect.

- **Blue Star Equity Group — Strategic Technology Advisor:** Organized and streamlined the IT function across the holding structure, defining standardized governance models, technology platforms, and operational workflows; drove the ERP evaluation that moved the business off QuickBooks onto Odoo, with multi-entity financial consolidation and reporting requirements setting the selection criteria.
- **PantryTab — Founder & Sole Architect:** Built and shipped a subscription SaaS platform end-to-end — React/TypeScript PWA, Supabase PostgreSQL with row-level security, Stripe billing, and a production Kroger API integration (OAuth 2.0, encrypted tokens) — running a nine-agent AI system with deliberate model routing that holds per-call cost between \$0.003 and \$0.02.
- **Exodus — AI operating platform:** Architected and operate an AI-agent platform (25+ Python services, ~15,000 lines) that runs multi-company operations through autonomous agents, with capital limits, risk sizing, and tiered decision authority enforced as code gate functions rather than model prompts — 20+ unattended production services with zero unrecovered failures.
- Designed a two-tier LLM cost architecture — frontier reasoning reserved for judgment-dense decisions, local open-weight models for high-frequency work — holding recurring inference cost near zero; found and eliminated a \$400/month runaway API cost leak and made cost projection a standing pre-deployment requirement.
- **Signal Works — AI shared services:** Built an AI-native shared marketing capability replacing per-company CMO functions, governed by a three-tier autonomy model (autonomous / orchestrator-gated / owner-gated) with structural human-approval locks on public-facing output and FTC compliance encoded as a machine-enforced constraint.
- **DreidHQ Capital — IT & Automation Consultant:** Designed secure file architectures, reporting environments, and governance processes improving reporting accuracy and data integrity.

Senior Director — Technology Operations, Infrastructure & Security

Liberty Steel USA | Peoria, IL / Dallas, TX | Jun 2023 – Aug 2024

Owned enterprise IT for a seven-site U.S. manufacturing business, leading ERP modernization, infrastructure transformation, cybersecurity governance, and vendor strategy.

- Managed a \$15M IT P&L across 7 manufacturing sites, leading an IT organization of 15 plus a dedicated ERP team, and delivered a 35% infrastructure cost reduction through network and platform modernization.
- Drove replacement of a legacy AS/400 environment with Epicor ERP across manufacturing operations — removing decades of accumulated technical debt and moving the business onto a supportable modern platform.
- Architected and executed a three-year technology roadmap aligned to business growth targets, sequencing modernization of legacy platforms against operational priorities and contract renewal timing.
- Established enterprise cybersecurity governance aligned to the NIST framework, materially reducing risk exposure and improving regulatory readiness without slowing operations.
- Restructured the vendor ecosystem through competitive RFP and renegotiation, achieving 20% cost optimization while improving service levels and accountability.
- Replaced manual reporting with Power BI analytics, digitized paper-based finance workflows, and built a centralized IT Service Desk standardizing delivery across sites.

Senior Director of IT Strategy & Architecture

Wilks Brothers LLC | Fort Worth, TX | May 2021 – Jun 2023

Set enterprise technology strategy for a private equity holding company operating 27+ portfolio businesses across 17 industries and \$1.5B+ in annual revenue.

- Directed the enterprise systems agenda across the portfolio — including migration from Microsoft Dynamics NAV to Dynamics 365 and an Odoo ERP implementation on the manufacturing side — consolidating duplicate business systems and rationalizing licensing and integration overhead as part of \$750K in annual savings against a \$12M budget.
- Directed enterprise cloud migration to Microsoft Azure — 165+ servers — improving application performance and reducing recovery time objective to four hours.
- Established enterprise architecture and integration standards that allowed newly acquired companies to be onboarded onto shared platforms rather than absorbed as permanent one-off environments.
- Led enterprise Zero Trust implementation and strengthened identity, access, and governance controls across every portfolio company; consolidated telecom and network infrastructure, removing \$400K in recurring annual expense.
- Built and led a 30+ person organization and a technology governance framework that balanced shared standards against genuinely different business unit needs, ensuring ROI on technology investment.

Director of IT Operations & Enterprise Solutions

Wilks Brothers LLC | Fort Worth, TX | May 2014 – May 2021

Built the operating foundation of the portfolio technology function during the company's most acquisitive period.

- Led technology integration across 11 acquisitions, stood up technology for 6 companies built from the ground up, and executed 3 divestitures — consolidating business systems, migrating data, and unifying identity and infrastructure to deliver \$5M+ in recurring annual synergies.
- Rebuilt enterprise identity and access management, reaching 100% MFA adoption and cutting security incidents by 85%.
- Established an enterprise PMO and a centralized ITSM platform, standardizing governance, reporting, and Incident/Request/Change processes across multi-company project portfolios.
- Improved reliability from frequent outages to 99% uptime, achieved 21% budget optimization, removed \$175K in annual provisioning labor cost, and sustained 93% employee retention through continuous organizational change.

Manager of Client Services

FTS International | Fort Worth, TX | Nov 2010 – May 2014

- Led a 28-member IT organization supporting three administrative offices plus remote sites and mobile field units, sustaining 99% uptime on a \$1.6M OPEX/CAPEX budget.
- Owned delivery for a divestiture, an acquisition domain migration, an MDM selection from RFP through vendor demos, and a 700-device PC refresh completed with in-house staff.

Earlier Career

Capgemini Energy & HCL America — Client Services Team Manager (TXU Energy, Oncor, Luminant, Energy Future Holdings) • Yellowbook USA — IT Operations • Northwest Texas Healthcare System — IT Operations and HIPAA compliance.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Science, IT Network Administration — Western Governors University, 2014

ITIL v3 • CompTIA Security+ • CompTIA Project+ • PMI CAPM • Lean Six Sigma White Belt

Community: Lead Goalkeeper Coach — Solar Soccer Club (ECNL Regional League NTX, 2024–2025); previously Hurst FC and Allegiance FC.